

hdparm

This system is used to tune disk drive performance. It is not essential and, unless configured, does not do anything. The configuration file is `/etc/hdparm.conf` and it is not enabled by default.

hplip

This provides Linux support for the HP Linux Image and Printing system. If you do not need it, then it can be disabled. Without this, you can still print using the `lpr` and CUPS systems.

mdadm, mdadm-raid, and lvm

These provide file system support for RAID (`mdadm` and `mdadm-raid`) and Logical Volume groups (`lvm`). If you do not use either, then these can be disabled.

nfs-common, nfs-kernel-server, and portmap

These are used by NFS—they are only present if you installed NFS support. If you do not need NFS all the time, then you can disable these and only start the services when you need them:

```
sudo /etc/init.d/portmap start
sudo /etc/init.d/nfs-common start
sudo /etc/init.d/nfs-kernel-server start
```

pcmcia and pcmciautils

These provide support for PCMCIA devices on laptops. If you do not have any PCMCIA slots on your computer, then you do not need these services.

powernowd and powernowd.early

These services are used to control variable-speed CPUs. Newer computers and laptops should have these enabled, but older systems (for example, my dual-processor 200 MHz PC) do not need it.

readahead and readahead-desktop

These services are used to preload libraries so some applications will initially start faster. In a tradeoff for speed, these services slow down the initial boot time of the system and consume virtual memory with preloaded libraries. If you have limited RAM, then you should consider disabling these services.

rsync

This is a replacement for the remote copy (`rcp`) command. Few people need this—it is used to synchronize files between computers.